

Yang Tao

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Cancer Epidemiology Unit, Richard Doll Building, Old Road Campus, Oxford OX3 7LF

EDUCATION

University of Oxford

Oxford, UK

DPhil Candidate in Population Health (Epidemiology)

2022–2026

Thesis title: *Dietary factors, biomarkers and bone health: evidence from three large cohort studies*

Supervisors: Prof Tammy Tong, Dr Keren Papier, Prof Timothy Key, Prof Gillian Reeves

Columbia University

New York, NY

Master of Science in Nutrition and Public Health

2014–2017

GPA 4.0/4.0

Sun Yat-Sen University (SYSU)

Guangzhou, China

Bachelor of Medicine in Preventive Medicine

2008–2014

GPA 3.8/4.0; Rank: 1/16 in major, 2/140 in cohort

RESEARCH AND CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher, Cancer Epidemiology Unit, University of Oxford, UK

2022–*Present*

Senior Research Assistant, Yuan Lab, Zhejiang University School of Medicine, China

2021–2022

Physician, Department of Nutrition, First Medical Center, PLA General Hospital, China

2018–2021

Core Rotations, SYSU Third Hospital / Kaiping Central Hospital / SYSU Cancer Center, China

2012–2013

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Oxford Population Health Studentship (Full Scholarship), University of Oxford

2022–2026

Doctoral Research Allowance, Nuffield Department of Population Health, University of Oxford

2022–2026

Hong Kong PhD Fellowship (HKPFS, declined), Research Grants Council of Hong Kong

2022

Global Nutrition Early Career Scholar Award, American Society for Nutrition

2022

Founders' Award & International Scholarship, Teachers College, Columbia University

2014

Open Laboratory Research Grant, Sun Yat-sen University

2011

Academic Research Excellence Scholarship, Sun Yat-sen University

2011

Eisai Enterprise Scholarship, Eisai Co., Ltd. & Sun Yat-sen University

2010

Merit Scholarship, Sun Yat-sen University. Three separate scholarships.

2009, 2010, 2012

PUBLICATIONS

* *Corresponding author*; † *Equal contribution*. Full list available at *Google Scholar*

Selected First-, Co-first, and Corresponding-Author Papers

- [1] Yang Tao* Timothy J. Key, Gillian K. Reeves, Sarah Floud, Keren Papier, Tammy Y.N. Tong. Diet-wide association study of foods and nutrients with hip fracture risk: a prospective cohort study of 21,369 incident cases among 542,068 postmenopausal women. *medRxiv* Preprint. 2026. [DOI]
- [2] Liyan Huang† Yang Tao† . . . , and Changzheng Yuan. Mediterranean-Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension Intervention for Neurodegenerative Delay (MIND) Diet and Cognitive Function and its Decline: A Prospective Study and Meta-analysis of Cohort Studies. *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition*. 2023 Jul;118(1):174-182. [DOI]
- [3] Hui Chen† Yang Tao† . . . , and Changzheng Yuan. Temporal patterns of energy intake and cognitive function and its decline: a community-based cohort study in China. *Life Metabolism*. 2022 Jul 7;1(1):94-97. [DOI]

Selected Co-authored Papers

- [1] Hui Chen, Jie Shen, Yang Tao, . . . , Changzheng Yuan. Circulating metabolomic profile of the MIND diet and its relation to cognition in middle-aged and older adults. *iMetaOmics*. 2025;2:e61. [DOI]
- [2] Hui Chen, Klodian Dhana, Yuhui Huang, Liyan Huang, Yang Tao, . . . , Walter Willett, Changzheng Yuan.

Association of the Mediterranean Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension Intervention for Neurodegenerative Delay (MIND) Diet With the Risk of Dementia. *JAMA Psychiatry*. 2023 Jun 1;80(6):630-638. [DOI]

- [3] Liyan Huang, Yang Tao, . . . , Changzheng Yuan. The association between MIND diet and cognitive function among Chinese middle aged and older adults: A 9-year longitudinal study. *Alzheimer's & Dementia*. 2023;19(Suppl. 8):e062668. [DOI]

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Proteins, amino acids, fibre and IGF-1, European Prospective Investigation into Cancer, Milan, Italy (*Poster*) 2025
 DWAS with hip fracture risk, International Congress of Nutrition, Paris, France (*Poster*) 2025
 DWAS with hip fracture risk, NDPH Symposium, University of Oxford, UK (*Oral presentation*) 2024

STATISTICAL AND COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

- Expertise in large-scale cohort analyses, longitudinal and time-to-event modelling, causal inference
- Experience with high-dimensional data analysis, including proteomics and biomarker data
- Proficient in Stata and R for data processing, epidemiologic modelling, visualization, and HPC computing

MENTORING AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Mentor, UNIQplus Research Internship programme, University of Oxford 2026
Tutor, Epidemiology tutorials for medical students (BM BCh program), University of Oxford 2024, 2026
Teaching Assistant, Stata tutorials for Biostatistics (MSc GHSE), University of Oxford 2025
Teaching Assistant, Medical Nutrition I & II (Graduate-level elective), Columbia University 2016

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE AND OUTREACH

Volunteer Speaker, Lifelong Aging Fair, Brixton, London, UK 2024
 Intern, Hospital for Special Surgery, New York, USA 2017
 Intern, New York City Department of Health and Mental Hygiene, New York, USA 2016
 Intern, Guangzhou Center for Disease Control and Prevention, Guangzhou, China 2013–2014

LICENSURE AND CREDENTIALS

Physician License (Public Health), National Health Commission, China
 Registered Dietitian Nutritionist (RDN), Commission on Dietetic Registration, USA

REFERENCES

Prof Tammy Tong, PhD

Associate Professor

UKRI Future Leaders Fellow

University of Oxford

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(DPhil Supervisor)

Prof Timothy Key, DPhil

Emeritus Professor of Epidemiology

University of Oxford

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(DPhil Supervisor)

Prof Changzheng Yuan, ScD

Research Professor

Zhejiang University School of Medicine

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(Research Supervisor)

Dr Keren Papier, PhD

NDPH Fellow

Senior Nutritional Epidemiologist

University of Oxford

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(DPhil Supervisor)

Prof Gillian Reeves, PhD

Valerie Beral Professor of Epidemiology

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(DPhil Supervisor)